

# Comparatives and Superlatives

## comparative adjectives

| Adjective          | Comparative                |                                                      |
|--------------------|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| short              | shorter                    | one syllable: + <i>er</i>                            |
| big                | bigger                     | one vowel + one consonant:<br>double final consonant |
| busy               | busier                     | consonant + <i>y</i> : <i>y</i> + <i>ier</i>         |
| relaxed            | more relaxed               | two or more syllables:<br><i>more</i> + adjective    |
| good<br>bad<br>far | better<br>worse<br>further | Irregular                                            |

## comparative adverbs

| Adjective | Comparative  | Adjective | Comparative |
|-----------|--------------|-----------|-------------|
| Regular   |              | Irregular |             |
| quickly   | more quickly | hard      | harder      |
| slowly    | less slowly  | well      | better      |
|           |              | badly     | worse       |

- Use comparative adjectives to compare people and things.  
*My brother's taller than me.*
- Use comparative adverbs to compare actions.  
*He drives more slowly than me.*
- You can also use (not) *as* + (adjective / adverb) + *as*.  
*I'm not as tall as my brother.*  
*He doesn't drive as fast as me.*

## superlatives (+ *ever* + present perfect)

| Adjective | Comparative    | Superlative        |
|-----------|----------------|--------------------|
| cold      | colder         | the coldest        |
| hot       | hotter         | the hottest        |
| pretty    | prettier       | the prettiest      |
| beautiful | more beautiful | the most beautiful |
| good      | better         | the best           |
| bad       | worse          | the worst          |
| far       | further        | the furthest       |

- Use *the* + superlative adjectives to say which is the biggest, etc. in a group.  
*It's the highest mountain in Europe. She's the best in the class.*
- We often use a superlative with the present perfect.  
*Russia is the coldest place we've ever been to.*  
*It's the most beautiful church I've ever seen.*

### a Write comparative sentences.

London is / expensive / Manchester.

*London is more expensive than Manchester.*

- 1 my sister is / thin / me.
- 2 I'm / busy / this week / last week.
- 3 Cambridge is / far from London / Oxford.
- 4 I did the second exam / bad / the first.
- 5 Chelsea played / well / Arsenal.
- 5 the men in my office work / hard / the women.
- 6 my new job is / boring / my old one.

### b Rewrite the sentences so they mean the same. Use *as... as*.

Mike is stronger than Jim. Jim isn't *as strong as Mike*.

- 1 Cindy is taller than Kelly. Kelly isn't \_\_\_\_\_.
- 2 Your case is heavier than mine. My case isn't \_\_\_\_\_.
- 3 Mexico City is bigger than London. London isn't \_\_\_\_\_.
- 4 Football is more popular than tennis. Tennis isn't \_\_\_\_\_.
- 5 Children learn languages faster than adults. Adults don't \_\_\_\_\_.
- 6 You work harder than me. I don't \_\_\_\_\_.
- 7 France played better than England. England didn't \_\_\_\_\_.

### a Complete the sentences with a superlative.

Is this *the noisiest* city in the world? (noisy)

- 1 Yesterday was \_\_\_\_\_ day of the year. (hot)
- 2 This is \_\_\_\_\_ time to drive through the city centre. (bad)
- 3 She's \_\_\_\_\_ person in the class. (friendly)
- 4 This is \_\_\_\_\_ part of the exam. (important)
- 5 The \_\_\_\_\_ month to visit is September. (good)
- 6 It's \_\_\_\_\_ city in the world. (polluted)
- 7 The \_\_\_\_\_ I've ever flown to is Australia. (far)

### b Write sentences with *ever*.

it / hot country / I be to

*It's the hottest country I've ever been to.*

- 1 it / good film / I / see
- 2 he / unfriendly person / I / meet
- 3 it / hard exam / he / do
- 4 they / expensive shoes / she / buy
- 5 it / long book / I / read
- 6 she / beautiful girl / I / see
- 7 it / bad meal / I / have